KATE BRADLEY / SIGNAL REPORT

The commercial companion.

Additional research on making a living from the work, and building a body of work that can keep earning.



NOVEMBER 2026 / RESEARCH SUPPLEMENT

Prepared for Kate Bradley. The following pages preserve the commercial evidence and assumptions omitted from the main report.

HOW TO USE THIS EDITION

A plan to test.

Paid assignments offer the clearest early commercial test. Publishing and original products can develop alongside them, with licensing and software considered when there is evidence of useful, repeatable demand.

The research does not establish Katie's current audience, delivery capacity or likelihood of reaching the illustrated sales volumes. Published prices describe offers. Historical earnings describe those businesses. Neither is a promise of Katie's results.

All Katie prices, sales quantities and conversion rates are proposed or hypothetical unless identified otherwise. Proceeds after transaction fees still precede other costs. A 25% reserve is a planning assumption, not an estimate of her tax liability. Amounts are USD unless stated otherwise.

The arithmetic preserves the models from the research handoff. Annual subscription cash and annual licenses are shown as monthly equivalents only for comparison. One transaction must never be counted twice. Full source URLs appear with the relevant evidence.

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01 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Income comparables

Published figures, and the limits of each comparison.

No verified ranking of the highest-earning writers in this niche was established. Organizational revenue, personal compensation and advertised fees describe different things.

Open Stories Foundation

The fiscal 2024 Form 990 data lists organizational revenue of $1,120,862. John Dehlin's compensation is listed at $220,320, with $27,764 separately in the other-compensation column. The organization's revenue is not his personal income. https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/272026793

Jeanna Kadlec

In May 2026, Kadlec said her paid-subscriber income had previously exceeded $25,000 annually and later declined. This is self-reported historical income, not verified current profit. Her newsletter was Astrology for Writers, so the earnings cannot be attributed to deconstruction content.
https://jeannakadlec.substack.com/p/after-seven-years-im-leaving-substack

Annie Duke

Leading Authorities publishes indicative speaking ranges of $55,000-$75,000 locally and $75,000 or more for its other listed regions. These are changeable bureau guidelines, not disclosed contracts or annual earnings. Her established reputation makes this a business-model example, not a starting-price benchmark for Katie. https://www.leadingauthorities.com/speakers/annie-duke

Blake Chastain

His October 2021 funding post offered $8 monthly support and sought 1,000 new paid subscribers. He said the work did not then supply full-time income. The target is not an achieved count, and the price is historical. https://www.postevangelicalpost.com/p/the-next-chapter-for-the-post-evangelical

02 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Market context

Audience size is context. It is not a sales forecast.

Pew's 2014 study, published in 2015, estimated that 8.4% of all U.S. adults had been raised evangelical Protestant and no longer identified with that tradition. This is an older historical estimate. It includes movement to other religious traditions and must not be presented as the current size of a secular deconstruction audience. No verified current equivalent evangelical headcount found in the opened sources. https://www.pewresearch.org/religion/2015/05/12/chapter-2-religious-switching-and-intermarriage/

Dollar market size

No verified source found for a defensible U.S. dollar market size for faith-deconstruction support or religious-trauma services as a distinct category. Do not use the total mental-health, wellness, or self-help market as a substitute. Individual provider prices demonstrate offers, not aggregate spending.

Relocation spending

Porch Group's December 2024 investor presentation estimated addressable markets of $3.5 billion for local full-service moving, $0.4 billion for labor-only moving, and $1.0 billion for ancillary services. These are company-defined market estimates, not measured annual spending on life-transition guidance. They should remain background context rather than a market-size claim for Katie.

https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1784535/000178453524000148/prch-20241205_exx991.htm

Atlas Van Lines' current corporate relocation survey describes responses from 549 decision-makers responsible for employee relocation. It supports investigating employers as a buyer category, but the overview inspected does not establish total U.S. spending on settling-in content.

https://www.atlasvanlines.com/resources/corporate-relocation-survey

Direct answer: No verified source found for total annual American spending on the particular relocation support or life-transition materials Katie might supply. The original IBISWorld market-size page could not be retrieved, so widely repeated moving-industry totals were not admitted as verified original-source evidence. Even a verified moving-industry total would mostly measure services outside her proposed offer.

PODS' April 2026 Moving Mindset Study surveyed 1,000 Americans who had moved during the preceding three years; half described their latest move as a fresh start. It is a moving-company-sponsored survey, not a solo-mover study. https://www.pods.com/resource-center/news/pods-moving-mindset-study-why-americans-are-moving

03 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Questions worth asking

Find the specific problem before developing the product.

These are original questions to test with readers, not quotations, demonstrated gaps in all existing resources, or claims about Katie's private life.

Family after a change in belief

How do I decide which family traditions I still want? What do I explain when I have made a decision without reaching certainty? How do I remain close to someone who regards my changed beliefs as a mistake?

Arriving alone

How do I compare neighborhoods when I cannot visit each one? What needs to be arranged before arrival, and what can wait? How do I build dependable local connections when I arrive alone?

A useful reader interview

Ask readers to describe a recent situation, what they tried, and what remained unresolved. Ask which resources they used before calling a subject underserved. If an answer suggests a practical resource, show a small sample and test whether people use or purchase it. Interest alone does not establish willingness to pay.

04 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Writing that organizations buy

Price comparisons and buyer categories to investigate.

Natasha Tynes advertises Substack ghostwriting starting at $1,200 monthly for setup plus two newsletters, $2,000 for four newsletters with voice development, and $2,800 with additional content and collaboration work. The client supplies ideas through an interview or voice note. These are advertised starting prices, not documented receipts. https://www.natashatynes.com/substack

Bryant Duhon publishes a managed newsletter offer at $2,000 monthly plus $1,500 launch, and newsletter-plus-thought-leadership work starting at $4,000 monthly. His scope includes client interviews and defined ongoing content capacity. https://www.simplyusefulmarketing.co/p/pricing-and-services

Proposed Katie offer: A paid pilot consisting of one recorded interview and two newsletter drafts, with one revision round, for $750-$1,000. Start with a recruiting founder or a professional-services owner whose subject Katie can understand well enough to ask good questions. Supply a sample based on public information, clearly labeled as a demonstration rather than client work. Publishing or platform administration is a separate scope until her competence in that platform is demonstrated.

After a successful pilot, test a $1,500-$2,500 monthly retainer with a defined issue count and interview allowance. At $2,000 each, two clients equal $4,000 gross monthly and four equal $8,000; neither figure is take-home income. A hypothetical 16 delivery hours per client would make a $2,000 retainer $125 per delivery hour before sales, administration, expenses, or tax. If actual delivery takes 30 hours, that falls to about $66.67. Measure this during the pilot.

What makes it viable: The buyer already has something to communicate and lacks writing capacity. Katie sells a finished piece of work rather than asking strangers to finance her audience growth. She must demonstrate voice fidelity and accuracy, and avoid promising audience or lead growth she cannot control.

Scale limit: Four clients still mean four sets of deadlines. To grow further, she would need narrower scope, higher prices supported by results, or editorial help. This is an income foundation rather than passive revenue.

2. Case studies and researched guides

Mighty Fine Copy publishes $1,200 for a customer case study or $2,000 monthly for two, including customer interviews. Its newsletter service is $2,200 monthly for four weekly issues. This is useful evidence of several ways one writer sells business writing, without treating every format as an entirely separate profession. https://www.mightyfinecopy.com/services

Duhon lists substantial guides, whitepapers, and eBooks generally from $4,000. The EFA's 2026 chart reports business/marketing ghostwriting at $0.50-$1.00 per word or $87.50-$125 per hour, based on

reported 2025 rates. These are different pricing bases and do not imply identical scope or expertise. https://www.simplyusefulmarketing.co/p/pricing-and-services https://www.the-efa.org/rates/

Proposed Katie offer: Turn an interview with an actual customer into a 900-1,200-word case study, with a short sales summary and one revision round. Test $900-$1,500 depending on access and complexity. The client must authorize the interview and approve any results claimed. Four $1,200 stories in a month produce $4,800 gross. A larger $3,000 guide plus two $1,200 stories produces $5,400 gross. These are production scenarios, not booked assignments.

Her recruiting background gives her a possible entry point into hiring-related content. That does not automatically qualify her to interpret proprietary statistics or write deeply technical product material. Start where her subject knowledge is real and use interviews for information she cannot independently establish.

For context rather than starting-price advice, Scribe Media advertises interview-based book writing and publishing at $56,000, with an elite package at $135,000. These include a full team and publishing services; the amounts are not a freelance writer's compensation. Katie should not begin with a year-long book commitment because an impressive package price exists. https://scribemedia.com/pricing

3. Destination and newcomer writing

Livability Media provides content services to chambers of commerce and economic development organizations seeking to attract residents and talent. This establishes a real institutional buyer category for place-based writing. No commission price for Katie was verified. https://livabilitymedia.com/our-story/

San Diego Regional EDC's San Diego: Life. Changing. initiative uses neighborhood profiles and other resources to help employers recruit talent. It also provides free recruiting resources. A generic newcomer checklist would therefore compete with substantial free material. https://www.sandiegobusiness.org/about-edc/our-initiatives/san-diego-life-changing/

Dwellworks supplies destination services and local information. This demonstrates existing provision and a possible buyer or partner category, not an open writing contract or willingness to license Katie's material. https://www.dwellworks.com/services/destination-services

Proposed offer: A commissioned written guide for a specific group, such as recruits arriving without an established local network. Quote a small pilot at a hypothetical $1,500-$3,000 only after agreeing its research burden. Focus on a need the organization's free material does not resolve. A public directory by itself is unlikely to distinguish the offer.

Katie must first establish reliable local knowledge. Documenting her own move is a starting point, not qualification as a San Diego expert. Avoid regulated relocation services; the proposed work is researched publishing. Commissioned writing is likely to be an easier first conversation than persuading an institution to license an untested product.

Named organizations to investigate

These are research leads and examples of content use. No hiring opening, available budget, or intention to purchase from Katie has been established.

Organization	Observed activity	Appropriate first investigation
Ashby	Publishes original recruiting reports and a weekly Talent Trends newsletter. https://www.ashbyhq.com/talent-trends-report https://try.ashbyhq.com/talent-trends-newsletter/	Study the standard expected of recruiting content and whether its content team ever commissions outside writing. Do not offer statistical research skills Katie has not demonstrated.
Gem	Publishes customer stories about recruiting teams. https://www.gem.com/company/customers	Examine its customer-story format and look for a content or customer-marketing commissioning route.
Livability Media	Provides place-marketing content to institutional clients. https://livabilitymedia.com/our-story/	Verify its contributor or subcontracting process before pitching.
San Diego Regional EDC	Maintains talent-attraction resources through its named initiative. https://www.sandiegobusiness.org/about-edc/our-initiatives/san-diego-life-changing/	Ask what newcomer questions their existing materials leave unresolved and how external content is commissioned.
Dwellworks	Uses destination information and checklists in its relocation service. https://www.dwellworks.com/services/destination-services	Investigate how destination content is sourced and updated; substantial existing resources make differentiation essential.

Smaller recruiting firms and agencies may offer a more accessible first client than these established organizations. Use the named examples to understand what is bought and published, then identify comparable buyers with a manageable decision process. No messages have been sent.

05 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

The paid publication

Substack economics, audience requirements and retention.

Proposed starting price and verified fees

Use $8/month, $80/year, and an optional $200/year founding level as a testable starting configuration. These are recommendations, not discovered willingness-to-pay figures. A $10/month or $100/year configuration is another test if the paid value becomes clear. Do not change prices repeatedly on the strength of a few responses.

Substack's published U.S. web-card fees are 10% of subscription revenue, 2.9% plus $0.30 for card processing, and 0.7% for recurring billing. The examples below therefore use payment × 0.864 − $0.30. They exclude refunds, disputes, international-card differences, in-app fees, sales taxes, and other payment methods. Calculations use unrounded percentage fees; actual transaction-level rounding can change the totals slightly. https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/360037607131-How-much-does-Substack-cost

Active paid subscribers	Gross monthly if all pay $8 monthly	After stated web-card fees, before expenses/tax	Monthly equivalent after fees if all pay $80 annually
100	$800	$661.20	$573.50
500	$4,000	$3,306.00	$2,867.50
1,000	$8,000	$6,612.00	$5,735.00
2,000	$16,000	$13,224.00	$11,470.00

At $80 annually, one subscriber generates $68.82 after these fees, or $5.735 a month when spread across the year. The cash arrives at payment; that does not make it repeat monthly income. Founding membership at $200 annually produces $172.50 after the same fees, equivalent to $14.375 a month.

What an $8,000 monthly personal-income goal requires

The table uses all-monthly subscriptions, $150 monthly operating costs, and an illustrative 25% reserve on the remainder. It solves subscriber proceeds − operating costs, then retains 75%. This is planning arithmetic rather than tax advice or a growth forecast.

Monthly subscription price	Proceeds per paid subscriber after modeled fees	Paid subscribers needed for $8,000 after modeled costs/reserve
$8	$6.612	1,636
$10	$8.340	1,297
$12	$10.068	1,075

These are substantial audiences of paying readers. A publication with 1,000 paying subscribers would require a total subscriber base of 100,000 if paid readers were 1% of the total, about 33,334 at 3%, or 20,000 at 5%. Those percentages are sensitivity assumptions, not an industry benchmark or Katie's expected conversion. Her current audience size and engagement were not established in this research.

Retention matters as much as initial sales. If a hypothetical 1,000-member monthly publication loses 3% of its paying readers in a month, it needs 30 new paying readers just to remain level. No churn rate for Katie has been established.

Substack supports annual group subscriptions and a higher founding-member plan. Use group access only when an organization has a clear reason to purchase seats. A subscription does not automatically include permission to copy or redistribute the writing.

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/360037465732-How-do-I-offer-group-subscriptions https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/360042039091-Can-I-set-up-another-subscription-plan-for-readers-who-want-to-pay-more

Recommendation: Develop Substack deliberately while service work supplies income. It can become a substantial business, but Katie should not base immediate housing or living commitments on an assumed conversion rate or launch date for that income.

06 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Products, rights and a backlist

Ways original work can serve more than one buyer.

4. A practical product sold repeatedly

The strongest product candidate should come from a problem readers repeatedly ask Katie to help examine. A hypothetical $49 decision toolkit could combine a concise written method with worked examples and reusable worksheets. A recruiting or business-process resource could be an entirely separate product if her professional experience reveals stronger demand there. Do not assume the personal readership will buy a professional resource.

Thomas Frank reports that his team made about $1 million selling Notion templates during 2022. He also describes a long content-building history and a team of eight at the time of the disclosure. This is first-person historical business revenue, not audited profit or an expected beginner outcome. It demonstrates a product scale mechanism, not demand for Katie's product.

https://typefully.com/TomFrankly/dollar1-million-in-notion-template-sales-kuFT0iD

Kit advertises commerce fees of 3.5% plus $0.30 per transaction, including payment processing. It supports digital products and automated delivery. It could serve only as a product checkout while Katie keeps publishing on Substack; no platform migration is recommended here. https://kit.com/pricing

https://kit.com/features/commerce

Hypothetical $49 toolkit sales during one month	Gross sales	After modeled 3.5% + $0.30 transaction fees
25	$1,225	$1,174.63
100	$4,900	$4,698.50
500	$24,500	$23,492.50

These exclude product development, customer support, acquisition, refunds, and tax. The 500-sale row is a scale illustration, not a recommended launch target. At a hypothetical 2% purchase rate, 100 sales would require 5,000 qualified product-page visits; 2% is an assumption and must be replaced by observed performance.

If Katie chooses a Notion product, the platform's marketplace is another distribution route, subject to seller onboarding and review. Its current documented transaction fee is 8% plus $0.40. That route requires actual Notion-building competence; it is not necessary for a useful PDF or spreadsheet product.

https://www.notion.com/help/selling-on-marketplace

5. Organizational licensing

Once a resource has proved useful, Katie could test selling limited rights to distribute it to a defined audience. A possible example is a newcomer preparation pack licensed to a recruiting or relocation business. Its value would need to exceed what that organization already gives away. The organization pays for defined reuse rather than another individually commissioned document.

Susan David's business offers custom learning content and licensing inquiries. Its published terms distinguish licensed materials from broad rights to reuse a methodology. William Bridges Associates has a certification model for delivering its transition workshops. Both are established systems with expertise and delivery infrastructure; they demonstrate commercial structures rather than a shortcut for Katie.

https://shop.susandavid.com/products/custom-content-development https://shop.susandavid.com/pages/terms-conditions

https://wmbridges.com/training/leading-organizational-transition/

Hypothetical license to test later: $1,500 per organization per year for distribution to up to 100 named users, with two scheduled content updates. Custom branding and new research cost extra. No public comparable price was verified for this exact offer. Five such licenses produce $7,500 annual gross, ten produce $15,000, and 25 produce $37,500. Their monthly gross equivalents are $625, $1,250, and $3,125. More users may justify different pricing, but that willingness to pay is unverified.

This route depends on retaining rights to Katie's generic original material. A client's exclusive commissioned work cannot simply become her reusable product. Any eventual license must define permitted distribution, its term, and responsibilities for updates; it must not imply professional accreditation. These are proposed commercial requirements, not legal advice.

6. Books and a backlist

Katie's strongest essays could eventually support an original book or a focused series. The commercial appeal is a reusable backlist rather than a different custom deliverable for every reader. A book should follow a sustained reader question and a developed manuscript, rather than being treated as an automatic monetization step.

Amazon KDP documents 35% and 70% eBook royalty options, with eligibility conditions; the 70% calculation subtracts applicable VAT and delivery costs before applying the percentage.

https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G200644210

For an eligible, hypothetical $6.99 sale with no VAT and an assumed $0.10 delivery charge, royalty would be 0.70 × ($6.99 − $0.10) = $4.823. One hundred such copies produce about $482.30; 1,000 produce $4,823 before editing, design, marketing, or income tax. At those assumptions, about 1,659 sales are required to generate $8,000 in royalties before those other costs. This is a volume requirement, not a forecast. A direct-sale practical toolkit has different economics and should not be confused with a Kindle title.

No book advance or translation/audio licensing income is assumed. Those belong in the report as potential negotiated rights only when there is a real offer or a defensible comparable.

07 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Making the income add up

Combined models for an $8,000 monthly personal-income goal.

An $8,000 revenue business is not an $8,000 personal-income business. Under an illustrative $300 monthly overhead allowance and a 25% reserve after fees and overhead, the service revenue needed depends heavily on the collection fee.

Assumed percentage lost to platform/payment fees	Required monthly service billings to retain $8,000 after modeled overhead/reserve
0%	$10,966.67
10%	$12,185.19
15%	$12,901.96

The zero-fee row is a mathematical baseline, not a claim that direct clients cost nothing to acquire or collect from. Upwork's documented freelancer fee ranges from 0% to 15% per contract and is shown before acceptance; use the actual displayed fee when pricing a job. Connects and other costs belong in overhead. https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/211062538-Learn-about-the-Freelancer-Service-Fee?mobile_site=true

Two internally consistent examples

Service-led example: Four clients at a hypothetical $2,500 monthly plus one $3,000 guide produce $13,000 gross. Deduct a modeled 10% collection/platform cost and $300 overhead, then reserve 25%: the remainder is $8,550. This requires five successful client relationships or assignments that month. It does not mean Katie should accept all that work immediately. At assumed delivery times of 16 hours per retainer and 24 hours for the guide, delivery alone takes 88 hours; sales, administration, and her publication need additional time.

Mixed example after audience development: Three $2,500 retainers produce $6,750 after an assumed 10% fee. Six hundred annual subscribers at $80 produce a $3,441 monthly equivalent after the modeled Substack fees. Twenty-five $49 toolkit sales add about $1,174.63 after the modeled Kit fees. Combined proceeds are about $11,365.63; after $600 monthly overhead and a 25% reserve, approximately $8,074.22 remains. Annual subscription cash is uneven, and the subscriber and product-sale counts are assumptions. This is an illustration of how ownership can reduce dependence on client hours, not a near-term prediction.

These routes may share readers, so their conversion assumptions must be tested separately. Do not count an included toolkit as an additional sale, count a founding member again as a standard paid subscriber, or treat upfront annual cash as twelve separate monthly payments. Neither example includes subcontractors; a growing studio needs a new margin model.

08 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

The first four weeks

A sequence for testing paid work and protecting writing time.

Week one, proposed: Select either the newsletter pilot or the case-study offer based on the strongest existing writing sample. Prepare one clearly labeled demonstration and a one-page scope. For recruiting content, draw on Katie's actual experience rather than learning an unrelated technical industry while trying to sell into it. Start her own Substack publishing schedule alongside this work.

Weeks two and three, proposed: Build a shortlist of 20 relevant buyers and seek a small number of paid-pilot conversations. Interview five plausible buyers about their current publishing workload and purchasing process. These counts are manageable test goals, not expected reply or sales rates. Upwork searches can include "newsletter ghostwriter," "customer case study writer," "recruiting content writer," and "white paper writer." They are search terms, not verified live jobs. Assess scope and client spending against the actual fee and research burden.

Week four, proposed: Review responses and delivery data. If buyers understand the offer but do not buy, investigate proof and price before creating another service. If no one sees a useful outcome, revise the offer or buyer selection. Record actual time spent so an attractive project fee does not disguise an unworkable hourly return.

For her own products, ask readers which decisions they are struggling with and test a small sample. Invite a few paid pilot purchases before building a large toolkit. A request for free advice is evidence of interest; payment and repeated use provide stronger commercial evidence. Publish no clinical claims and make no private history part of the sales proposition.

Do not launch a separate professional intelligence newsletter alongside her personal Substack immediately. If paying clients repeatedly request the same research, assess whether a separately positioned professional subscription would serve a clear buyer. Otherwise it would add an editorial obligation without established demand.

09 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

One publishing operation

The relationship between her site, Substack and discovery.

An owned website gives Katie a home for searchable articles and her commercial offers. Substack can handle the reader subscription and publishing relationship, while Pinterest supplies another way to discover useful articles. This is a proposed arrangement for testing, not an assumption that three platforms will automatically generate three incomes. One buyer purchase is one purchase, regardless of how many channels helped produce it.

Raquel can build the site, which makes this option more practical for Katie. Include the ongoing work of keeping it useful and maintaining it in the business economics. Katie still needs one manageable editorial operation rather than separate content schedules for every platform. A blog can be worthwhile without relying on an unverified claim that blogging overall is experiencing a comeback.



10 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

The Substack inventory

Different ways to bill, deliver value and attract a purchase.

This inventory covers the relevant mechanisms verified in the research. It separates billing arrangements from paid benefits and external transactions. It does not assume that all features are available on Katie's account or that she should offer every format.

The recurring U.S. web-card model remains charge × 0.864 − $0.30, before costs and tax. For rows showing gross only, processor charges and any negotiated commissions have not been verified for that transaction type. The examples in different rows overlap and must not be summed as independent revenue streams.

Mechanism	Example calculation, with hypothetical sales quantities	How it applies
Monthly subscriptions	500 × $8 = $4,000 gross monthly; modeled proceeds $3,306	The basic recurring purchase
Annual subscriptions	500 × $80 = $40,000 annual gross; $34,410 after modeled fees, equivalent to $2,867.50/month	Same membership billed annually; cash timing differs
Founding support	50 × $200 = $10,000 annual gross; modeled proceeds $8,625, or $718.75/month equivalent	Higher support tier; count these 50 people separately from standard members
Group subscriptions	10 organizations × 20 seats × hypothetical $64 annual seat price = $12,800 annual gross	Bulk purchase of subscriptions; not a separate licensing right
Gift subscriptions	25 × hypothetical $80 annual gift = $2,000 gross cash collected	Another person purchases access for the recipient; do not assume renewal
Paywalled essays and archive	100 genuinely additional $8 monthly subscribers = $661.20 modeled additional monthly proceeds	A reason to subscribe, not a separate payment for every archive visit
Paid audio or podcast	100 genuinely additional $8 subscribers = the same $661.20	Could extend Katie's essays without camera appearances; existing readers listening do not create extra revenue

Mechanism	Example calculation, with hypothetical sales quantities	How it applies
Paid Chat or member discussion	50 additional $8 subscribers = $330.60 modeled monthly proceeds	A benefit that can help subscriptions; moderation takes time
Paid live sessions, including audio-only	50 additional $8 subscribers = $330.60 modeled monthly proceeds	Subscription access, not verified per-event ticketing; optional for Katie
Subscriber Perks and downloads	100 genuinely additional $80 annual subscribers = $6,882 after modeled annual fees	A toolkit can be included as a subscription benefit; its inclusion is not also a retail sale
Substack brand sponsorship program	Hypothetical one $500 campaign = $500 gross before any negotiated fees	Eligibility and sponsor matching required; no universal rate verified
Direct issue sponsorship	Hypothetical four filled placements × $250 = $1,000 gross monthly	An external brand agreement; no guarantee of available sponsors or sold inventory
Podcast sponsor placements	Hypothetical four sold episode placements × $250 = $1,000 gross	Same sponsorship economics, with separate production work; not automatic payment per listen
Affiliate links	Hypothetical 100 attributable orders × $40 order value × 5% commission = $200	Payment from the affiliate program, subject to its actual rules, not Substack
Standalone product promoted in the newsletter	25 × $49 = $1,225 gross; about $1,174.63 after the modeled Kit checkout fee	External retail purchase; distinguish it from an included Perk
Commercial licenses and commissioned work	One hypothetical $1,500 license or $1,000 assignment = that contract's gross revenue	The newsletter supplies discovery or proof; the separate contract supplies income
Separately ticketed event promoted in the newsletter	20 × hypothetical $35 tickets = $700 gross	External ticketing transaction; additional event labor and fees apply
One-time reader support through an external checkout	20 hypothetical contributions × $10 = $200 gross	No native Substack tip-payment facility was verified; this requires a separate suitable payment route

Mechanism	Example calculation, with hypothetical sales quantities	How it applies
Pledges before enabling payments	100 pledges at $80 = $8,000 possible annual commitments, but $0 collected before activation	Do not report pledged amounts as cash or achieved recurring revenue
Notes, referrals, recommendations, and collaboration	Model $0 direct view income; attribute only subsequent real purchases	Distribution and conversion tools; no verified fixed payment per view found

Billing evidence: Substack documents monthly, annual, founding, gift, and group subscriptions. Its gift documentation explains that recipients can choose whether to buy when the gift ends.

https://substack.com/features

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/360037489632-How-do-I-give-a-paid-subscription-as-a-gift-on-Substack

Media and community evidence: Substack supports paid podcasts and paid-only Chat. Its live-streaming documentation includes paid access and an audio-only mode. This allows optional audio formats without making an on-camera persona a requirement. https://substack.com/how-to-start-a-podcast/paid-podcast

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/10410279875092-How-do-I-start-a-subscriber-chat-on-Substack

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/30316077882516-Getting-started-with-Live-Video-on-Substack

Subscriber Perks: The current feature supports digital downloads and external benefit links for selected paid tiers. The documentation says gifted and comped subscribers currently cannot redeem Perks. It is subscription-based delivery, not evidence of a native standalone product store.

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/50773191186324-What-are-Subscriber-Perks-on-Substack

Sponsorships: Substack's Creator Kit documentation currently specifies Bestsellers or publications with at least 100 paid subscribers. Matching does not guarantee a campaign; published standardized creator payouts were not found. Direct sponsored content is also permitted within its publishing rules.

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/50045576404500-How-do-I-set-up-a-Creator-Kit-on-Substack

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/4407986455188-Can-my-publication-host-sponsored-ads

Pledges: Readers enter payment details but are not charged until payments are enabled and their pledges convert. They are useful evidence of intent, not present earnings.

https://support.substack.com/hc/en-us/articles/11463706473108-What-are-Substack-Pledges

No native per-post retail payment, native cross-publication paid bundle, guaranteed platform view payout, or standard licensing marketplace was verified. Those cannot be entered into Katie's forecasts as existing features. External arrangements may still be possible, with their own contract and checkout.

11 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

The owned blog

Commercial offers first. Advertising as a conditional addition.

The site can sell Katie's original products and licenses, present services, and earn from appropriate commercial recommendations. It can also host display advertising once accepted by a suitable network. Products and professional work do not require reaching an ad-network traffic threshold first.

Site revenue source	Hypothetical economics	Commercial condition
Download or toolkit	100 × $49 = $4,900 gross; $4,698.50 after modeled Kit transaction fees	A qualified audience and a useful product; development and marketing still cost money
Larger product bundle	50 × proposed $99 = $4,950 gross; $4,761.75 after modeled Kit fees	Bundle must add useful value; no Katie demand or price validation yet
Membership	Use the actual chosen membership platform's fees and unique subscriber count	Avoid charging twice for the same membership unless the distinction is clear
Affiliate purchases	100 eligible $20 physical-book purchases × Amazon's published 4.5% category rate = $90	Approval, attribution, qualifying purchases, and current program rules apply
A higher-value commercial referral	20 confirmed referrals × an assumed $50 commission = $1,000	No such Katie agreement has been verified; require an actual written program offer
Advertorial or sponsored resource	Two assumed $750 commissions = $1,500 gross	A real buyer agreement and clear sponsorship labeling; no universal price
Professional inquiry	One $2,000 project = $2,000 gross	A qualified inquiry still has to become a signed and paid assignment
Reprint or organizational distribution rights	Ten assumed $1,500 annual licenses = $15,000 annual gross	The material must be hers to license, and buyers must value distribution rights
Books, ticketed discussions, or reader contributions	Use the corresponding transaction models above	These are optional arrangements, not requirements to turn Katie into a coach

Amazon's U.S. standard statement currently lists physical books at 4.5%. This is a relatively small revenue amount per book purchase, so a reading list is not by itself an $8,000 monthly business model.

https://affiliate-program.amazon.com/help/node/topic/GRXPHT8U84RAYDXZ

Display advertising: what the traffic must produce

Use publisher revenue per 1,000 pageviews, after the ad provider's share, consistently. The following $10/$25/$40 page-RPM values are sensitivity assumptions, not promised network rates or verified benchmarks for Katie's subject matter.

Monetized monthly pageviews	At assumed $10 page RPM	At assumed $25 page RPM	At assumed $40 page RPM
10,000	$100	$250	$400
25,000	$250	$625	$1,000
50,000	$500	$1,250	$2,000
100,000	$1,000	$2,500	$4,000
250,000	$2,500	$6,250	$10,000

At $25 page RPM, $8,000 in ad proceeds alone requires 320,000 monetized pageviews monthly before operating costs and tax. Under an illustrative $100 monthly cost and 25% reserve, about 430,667 monetized pageviews would be required to leave $8,000. These are mathematical requirements, not traffic forecasts. A session and a pageview are different units.

Current entry requirements: Journey documents at least 1,000 premium sessions in 30 days, GA4, original content, and other quality requirements. Its help page excludes incompatible CMS examples including Wix and Blogspot. Mediavine's full offering currently uses a minimum $5,000 annual ad-revenue requirement rather than the old often-quoted session threshold. Raptive specifies at least 25,000 monthly pageviews plus geography, site, and domain-age requirements. Meeting a minimum is not approval. Verify CMS compatibility before choosing the build.

https://journeymv.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/24633185741723-Journey-Minimum-Requirements

https://www.mediavine.com/application-requirements/

https://help.raptive.com/hc/en-us/articles/360032840891-Who-is-eligible-for-Raptive

These options make the blog commercially useful, but display ads should not be its sole business case. Katie's eventual subject mix also needs to fit an ad partner's actual content standards.

12 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Pinterest and platform choices

Follow the path from discovery to an actual transaction.

Pinterest documents affiliate links, brand partnerships, and outbound links to a website. It says payments for those monetization arrangements are organized with the brands or affiliate programs. No general payment per Pin impression was verified.

https://create.pinterest.com/creators/grow-and-succeed/?change_language=true%23earn-money

Use impressions to calculate potential visits, then attribute completed transactions. For illustration only, assume 0.5% of impressions produce an outbound visit and 2% of those visits eventually produce a $49 product purchase. This is an end-to-end purchase rate, not a measured Katie result.

Monthly Pin impressions	Outbound visits at assumed 0.5%	Product purchases at assumed 2% of those visits	Product proceeds after modeled Kit fees
100,000	500	10	$469.85
500,000	2,500	50	$2,349.25
1,000,000	5,000	100	$4,698.50

If 5,000 visits instead generate 1.5 monetized pageviews per visit at an assumed $25 page RPM, ad proceeds would be $187.50. The difference explains why sending appropriate readers toward a useful original product can matter more than maximizing impressions. Neither outcome is automatic, and ad and product revenue should be combined only where actual tracked activity supports both.

Start with helpful evergreen articles that fit Katie's real knowledge, then test Pins that accurately describe the article. Track outbound clicks and resulting subscribers or sales. A Pin for a free checklist should not be evaluated by impressions alone. A reading recommendation can use an approved affiliate arrangement, with the required disclosure. Do not choose a subject only because it is alleged to have a high payout.

Which platform offers the most useful monetization choices?

This comparison is limited to relevant writing-led platforms inspected for this task. Feature breadth does not establish which one will earn Katie the most.

Platform or arrangement	Verified commercial capability	Cost structure and tradeoff	Judgment for Katie
Owned website with appropriate tools	Direct sales, commercial pages, and room for suitable ads or memberships through integrations	Hosting and integrations vary; Raquel's build reduces initial implementation burden but not ongoing work	Greatest control over offers. A useful commercial home alongside Substack
Substack	Paid publishing with media/community benefits, gifts, group billing, Perks, and eligible brand matching	No required subscription software charge to start; percentage fees on reader subscriptions	Strong fit for Katie's stated publishing preference. Use its network and paid-reader relationship deliberately
beehiiv	Paid subscriptions, digital products, ad network, and paid outgoing recommendations	Current displayed entry Lite price is $49/month billed annually at the shown 1,000-subscriber band; subscriber scale and plans matter	Broad integrated newsletter monetization among the options inspected; worth comparing rather than assuming it pays more
Ghost	Website and newsletter with paid memberships; native one-time tips	Current displayed Publisher price is $29/month billed annually at 1,000 members, with 0% Ghost transaction share; Stripe and higher audience bands still cost money	Good alternative if one owned publication becomes more valuable than maintaining Substack; no migration is currently authorized or proposed as a prerequisite
Kit	Product checkout and email tools, including digital-product delivery	Published commerce fee 3.5% + $0.30; email plan costs depend on requirements	Can act as a narrow product-sales tool without replacing Katie's Substack
Pinterest	Discovery, outbound visits, affiliates, and direct brand arrangements	Organic use does not create guaranteed paid traffic or impression revenue	A distribution test rather than the core payment system

beehiiv's own pricing page lists 0% platform share on subscription and digital-product revenue. Its ad network documents campaign-specific CPM or CPC payments. Paid recommendations, formerly Boosts, pay for verified referred subscribers according to offers; some older Boosts formats have been retired.
https://www.beehiiv.com/pricing https://beehiivhelp.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/17507491038231-Ad-Network-FAQ
https://beehiivhelp.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/41790356251159-Boosts-to-paid-recommendations-what-changed

Ghost's plans and native tip feature are documented on its own site. The quoted low-price band does not cover an arbitrarily large free-plus-paid audience. https://ghost.org/pricing/ https://ghost.org/changelog/tips-donations/

Examples of beehiiv economics: Four campaigns each receiving 2,000 verified unique email opens at an assumed $5 CPM produce $40 total. Four campaigns with 50 payable clicks each at an assumed $2 CPC produce $400. These are alternative campaign models, not two payments for the same impression. In a separate hypothetical recommendation model, 1,000 new readers × 20% accepting a recommendation × 80% qualifying × $2 net publisher payout = $320. Offer availability, verification, and actual rates govern payment. Software cost and audience acquisition must then be deducted.

Platform-fee comparison: Avoiding a 10% platform share saves $50 at $500 subscription revenue or $500 at $5,000. A fixed software cost F breaks even on that component alone at gross subscription revenue = 10 × F. Thus $49 equates to $490 monthly gross and $100 to $1,000. This is not a migration recommendation: processor differences, higher audience bands, switching costs, and the value of discovery are excluded.

13 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

A publishing business at scale

A mature scenario and the practical website brief.

This deliberately excludes client retainers to show the scale of an ownership-led business. It is not a near-term forecast.

Hypothetical component	Monthly-equivalent proceeds before general costs and tax
650 unique $80 annual Substack subscribers, after modeled web fees	$3,727.75
100 standalone $49 toolkit purchases, after modeled Kit fees	$4,698.50
50,000 monetized blog pageviews at assumed $25 page RPM	$1,250.00
Ten separate $1,500 organizational licenses per year	$1,250.00 gross equivalent
Confirmed affiliate commission after reversals, assumed	$500.00
Total	$11,426.25

After an assumed $600 operating/collection allowance and a 25% reserve, the remainder is about $8,119.69. The allowance must cover any unmodeled license-payment fees; if actual costs are higher, the remainder falls. The same purchase cannot appear in the subscription, toolkit, and licensing rows. A toolkit included with membership is not a separate sale. The site needs sufficient qualified traffic, while annual cash must be managed across the year. This scenario shows a possible combination of mechanisms, not evidence Katie can achieve the assumed volumes.

The website brief

Create one clear article home, with a separate route to subscribe and a small shop or product page. Include a professional work page so a buyer can assess Katie's services without reading her entire personal archive. Choose a CMS that supports the intended commerce and ad integrations. A lightweight editable site is sufficient; a complex member portal is not necessary at launch.

Decide where each full public article lives. If publishing identical copies on the blog and Substack, verify canonical-link support and choose an original before syndicating. Otherwise use a useful excerpt and link to the full article. Maintain one consented subscriber destination for the main newsletter; do not create conflicting signup promises or silently add readers to unrelated lists.

Measure paid transactions and subscriber source, not just total traffic. Use campaign tags to distinguish Pinterest visits. Preserve the connection between the article that attracted a reader and any later purchase. Do not publish invented local expertise or mass-produce unverified articles to reach an ad threshold.

14 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

A route to earlier income

Upwork fit, defined projects and other commissioning channels.

Can Katie's skills command demand on Upwork?

There is credible evidence of demand for related work, but there is not yet evidence that Katie herself will be highly sought after. Her best opportunity is to turn a capability into a specific assignment that a client can evaluate. "I spot patterns" becomes more commercially useful when a buyer can inspect a research brief or see how it improves a piece of work.

Upwork's February 2026 investor release lists general research services, executive virtual assistance, digital project management, and market research among its most in-demand administrative/support skills. It also lists email marketing among its leading sales/marketing skills. Its methodology uses completed-job freelancer earnings from U.S.-originating demand during 2025, not a current count of open jobs or a promise of premium rates. https://investors.upwork.com/node/12681/pdf

That provides a category-level reason to investigate her fit. It does not establish low competition or that a new profile will receive invitations. Several live job pages could not be fully retrieved, so this research makes no verified-current-job or posted-budget claim. Named service-price comparisons in Part III remain the stronger pricing evidence.

Katie's reported background or strength	Purchasable assignment to test	Proof required before calling it a strength on her profile
Recruiting experience	Candidate research for a defined role, sourcing support, or hiring-process documentation	Evidence of the recruiting tasks and tools she has actually used; an anonymized relevant example
Executive-assistance experience and anticipation of problems	A scoped operating-process review with a clearer handoff checklist	A sample identifying specific preventable failures and usable improvements
Writing and simplifying complicated subjects	A researched article, customer case study, or founder newsletter	Strong samples with checked sources and a clear distinction between original and ghostwritten voice
Brand-deal and social-media work	Campaign operations support, deliverable tracking, or an editorial calendar	A credible description of her actual responsibilities; no invented sales results or negotiation expertise

The broad research categories do not qualify her to conduct statistical market research or make unsupported strategic claims. Write the profile around demonstrated tasks. Specialized recruiting or creator-operations knowledge may give her an advantage over a generic assistant listing, but that advantage still needs evidence.

Concrete introductory projects

These are proposed offers and unvalidated Katie prices. Use them to test buyer response, not as supposed Upwork averages.

Project	Proposed fixed scope and test price	Illustrative proceeds at a 10% Upwork fee
Newsletter pilot	Two draft issues based on one interview, one revision; $750-$1,000	$675-$900
Source-checked research brief	One tightly defined business/editorial question, documented sources and explicit limits; $400-$750	$360-$675
Customer story	One authorized customer interview and one written case study; $900-$1,500	$810-$1,350
Recruiting workflow documentation	One existing process mapped and rewritten into a usable handoff, without implementing automation; $500-$1,000	$450-$900
Creator campaign operations setup	One campaign tracker and delivery checklist from the client's actual process; $500-$1,000	$450-$900

Time-box the scope before quoting. The lower research price is viable only if the question is small enough to answer responsibly; it must not buy an entire market study. Track sales and revision time as well as delivery time. Use the actual fee shown on the contract, which can differ from the illustrative 10%.

Choose one primary profile direction from her best demonstrated work. A recruiting-oriented research/writing offer and an unrelated healing-content identity should not compete for attention in the same opening paragraph. Katie's personal publication can remain hers without becoming the sole explanation of what business clients can hire her to do.

Less obvious routes worth testing

Agency subcontracting for a defined part of the work

An agency already serving clients may need an interview turned into a case study or a set of sources turned into a clean editorial brief. Katie could sell that bounded contribution without first persuading an end client to buy an entire strategy engagement. An agency margin usually leaves less room than direct-client pricing; neither the existence nor the size of a margin should be guessed.

nDash's current freelancer offering explicitly includes writers, editors, and market researchers and supports direct work with brands or managed teams. Its writer page describes pitching brands after verification and setting rates. This is a specific route beyond Upwork, with portfolio and approval requirements rather than guaranteed placement. https://www.ndash.com/for-freelancers https://www.ndash.com/for-writers

Proposed first pitch scope: One article's source pack and interview outline at an assumed $350, or one interview-based case-study draft at an assumed $750. Three $750 accepted assignments equal $2,250 gross before fees and tax. These subcontract prices are test proposals, not advertised nDash rates. Confirm actual approval and payment terms before scheduling work around the proceeds.

Interview-to-document work

A founder or manager may have useful knowledge that has never become an article or an operating guide. Katie can test a paid assignment that captures one process through an interview and produces a document another person can use. This overlaps with her assistance experience more directly than launching a generalized "decision expert" consultancy.

Test a hypothetical $500 fixed project with one interview, one document, and one revision. Five such projects yield $2,500 gross, but five separate sales and handoffs may be more work than a retainer. The value is a smaller purchase decision and a useful proof of ability. A first interview is not permission to invent missing process steps; the client must validate the resulting document.

Editorial support for authors and podcasters

The same bounded research offer could support an author or a producer preparing an interview. The paid deliverable is checked background material, rather than a promise to find a sensational story. Her interests in history and psychology may help her stay engaged with this work, but interest is not scholarly qualification. Match the assignment to subjects she can research responsibly and the buyer's editorial standards.

This buyer hypothesis has no verified Katie contract value. Start with the small source-pack price above and measure the work. Do not rely on unsourced "expert researcher" credentials to make the offer seem more valuable.

Professional research participation as occasional bridge money

User Interviews advertises an average study incentive above $45 and requires participants to qualify for individual studies. Respondent advertises paid research opportunities selected through screening. These are ways to monetize genuine professional experience occasionally, not scalable businesses or reliable daily income. https://www.userinterviews.com/hello https://www.respondent.io/research-projects

Respondent's participant help specifies a 5% incentive fee with a $1 minimum. Three hypothetical $100 completed studies would leave $285 after that fee, before taxes and uncompensated screening time. This does not assume Katie will qualify for three studies. Some research requires a webcam or private video call; that differs from publishing herself publicly and may still be a preference constraint. Verify the actual reward and redemption options before treating it as available cash.
https://help.respondent.io/en/articles/5465041-why-is-my-participation-incentive-lower-than-expected

The high-priority commercial route remains paid work with a clear deliverable. Research participation belongs only as an optional supplement; no $8,000 plan should depend on it.

"Quickly" needs to mean usable payment, not just a signed assignment

A scoped pilot can be prepared and offered within days if her samples are ready. No reliable first-client deadline can be established from the available evidence. Warm introductions and previously satisfied employers or clients are sensible first avenues, without inventing a personal network or assuming permission to contact anyone.

On Upwork, fixed-price work can remain in client review for up to 14 days, followed by a five-day security hold after approval or automatic release; withdrawal adds its own timing. A quick completed project therefore does not guarantee immediately spendable money. https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/211063718-How-payments-for-milestones-and-fixed-price-contracts-work?mobile_site=true

For a legitimately direct client found outside a marketplace, a clearly agreed upfront project payment or deposit can reduce the gap between sale and cash. Any marketplace-sourced client remains subject to that marketplace's payment rules. The report should not suggest circumventing them.

Priority for the next two weeks

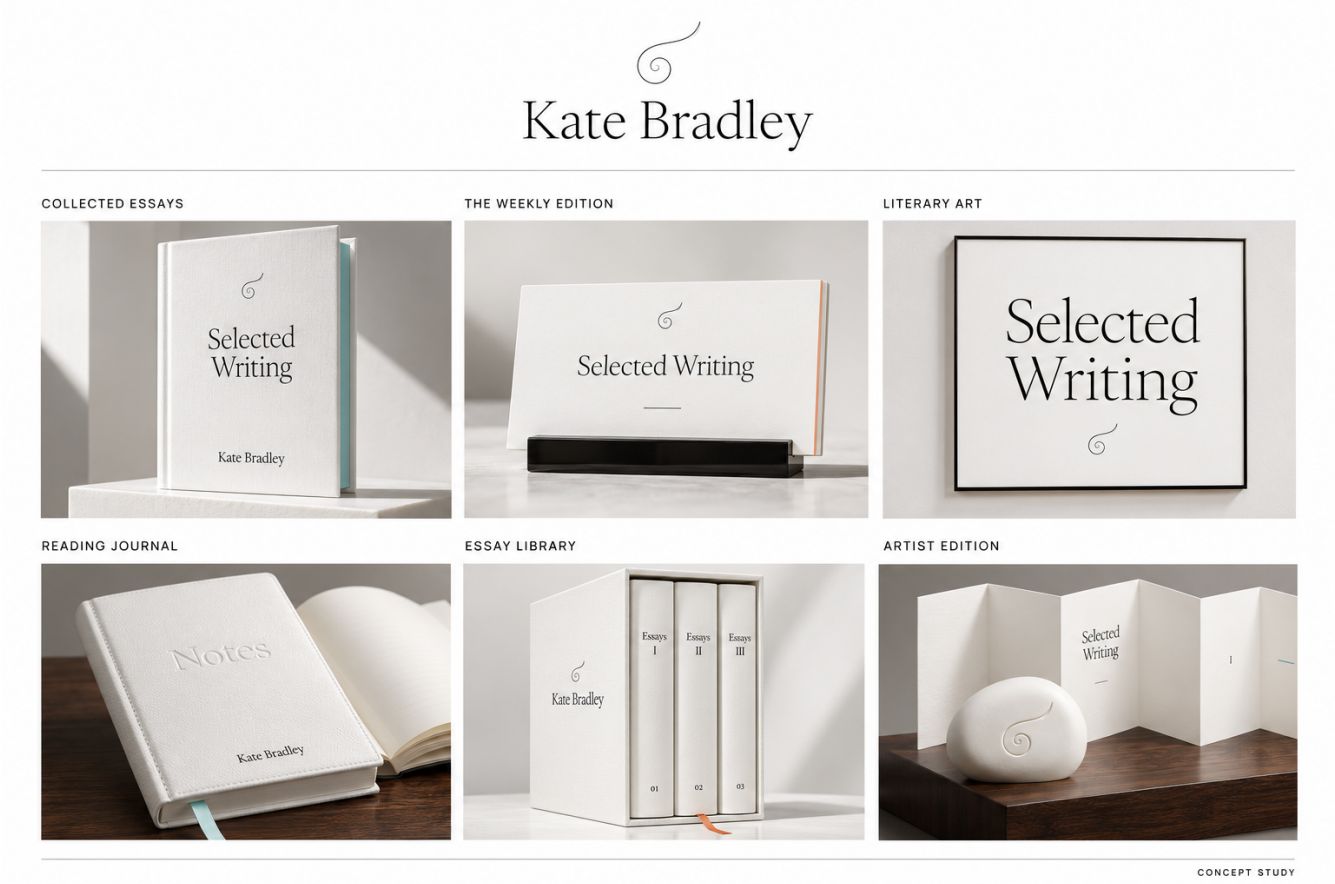
Katie should select the strongest sample she can stand behind. Package the matching small paid assignment, then test it with a focused group of appropriate buyers and on Upwork. Apply to a suitable writing/research network as a parallel channel if her samples meet its requirements. Her blog and Substack can make that work reviewable while she develops the longer-term publishing business.

The near-term goal is evidence of a repeatable paid transaction. Her longer-term opportunity is to retain and develop original assets so earnings need not remain tied to every hour she personally delivers. Audience-dependent revenue requires development; it should not be assumed to arrive in time to cover immediate living costs.

15 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

Editions worth keeping

Premium printed products, production risk and real margins.



Earlier application studies show possible formats, not final color proofs, finished products or functioning software. Final editions would use the selected saturated aqua and tangerine palette.

The commercial asset is Katie's original writing, developed into a coherent edition that a reader would keep or give. It does not need to become a short inspirational slogan. Select passages that remain meaningful outside their original essay, and preserve their context where that matters. No actual passages have been selected or approved during this research.

Product concept	Proposed form	Proposed retail range to test, not verified Katie pricing
Collected essay book	A finely typeset hardback or clothbound short book with original illustration or photography	$35-$65; a genuinely special signed edition could test higher pricing
Weekly reading stand	52 undated, professionally printed cards with substantial short readings and an elegant reusable stand	$45-$65
Literary art edition	One strong passage interpreted through original artwork or typography, printed on archival paper	$35-$75 unframed; framing priced after a real quote
Reading and reflection journal	A useful reading sequence from Katie's work, with carefully edited questions and room to respond	$35-$55
Boxed miniature essay library	Three small coordinated clothbound or beautifully printed volumes organized around a coherent subject	$65-$95
Artist collaboration	A limited artist book or sculptural object developed with a maker, with selected original text or visual interpretation	Quote and buyer test required; no defensible price established

These are concepts, not approved product names or completed manuscripts. A visually attractive blank journal would still need a reason to compete. Do not stretch a small amount of writing across many interchangeable products.

Real commercial comparisons

Obvious State sells illustrated literary prints on archival paper; many listed prints are $24. It demonstrates a way to turn writing into visual art, but famous literary passages and an established illustration practice are material differences from Katie's proposed collection.

https://obviousstate.com/collections/art-prints

Intelligent Change lists its boxed Mindful Affirmations with a beechwood stand at $32. The School of Life sells writing-based card sets and books, including a £150 limited collector's edition. Those establish a range of physical formats and price positions rather than Katie's expected sales.

https://www.intelligentchange.com/collections/gifts-stocking-stuffers/products/mindful-affirmations https://shop.theschooloflife.com/

Holstee's original manifesto has been developed into printed products; its page lists a 5-by-7 metallic print at $20 and links to wholesale/bulk purchasing. This is relevant to product extensions and gift distribution, not evidence that an unknown author's quotation will sell at volume.

https://www.holstee.com/pages/manifesto

What physical-product margins might look like

The following costs are invented planning inputs to illustrate the calculation, not supplier quotes. Obtain actual quotes and physical samples before committing to a run. Assume buyer-paid postage exactly covers outbound shipping; if Katie subsidizes shipping, subtract that subsidy. Transaction fees are modeled at 3.5% plus $0.30. The result is contribution before fixed overhead, development, unsold inventory, returns, acquisition, and tax.

Hypothetical product	Retail	Production cost assumption	Packaging	Fulfillment labor allowance	Contribution per sold unit
Weekly reading stand	$65	$18	$4	$3	$37.425
Boxed essay library	$85	$25	$4	$3	$49.725
Reflection journal	$48	$13	$3	$3	$27.020
Unframed literary print	$55	$12	$4	$3	$33.775

One hundred $65 reading stands generate $6,500 gross and, under those assumptions, $3,742.50 contribution. Subtract a hypothetical $1,000 development cost and $500 overhead, then reserve 25% of the remainder: about $1,681.88 remains. This is why a premium retail price does not by itself establish a large personal income. Production prices, packing labor, and sell-through must be confirmed.

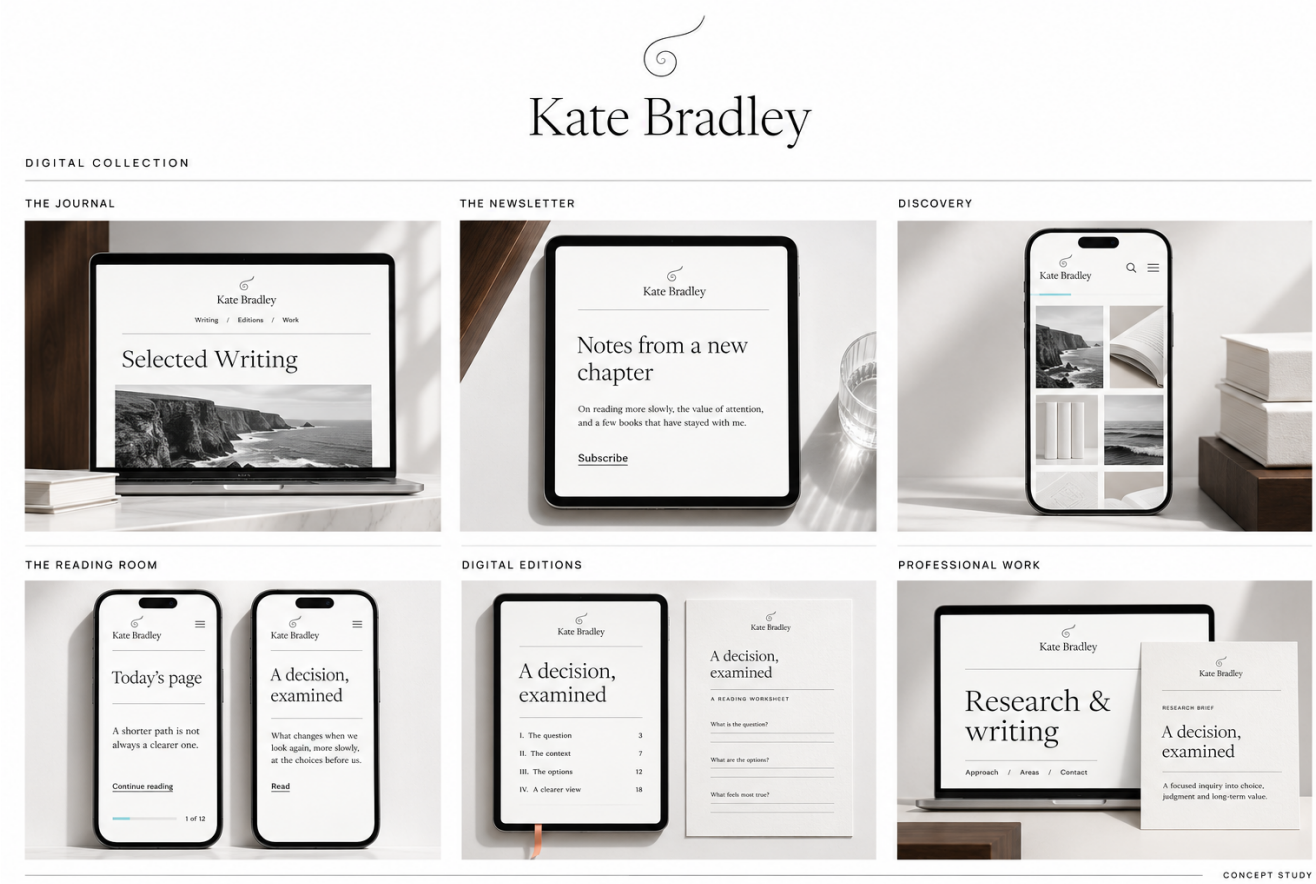
For wholesale, calculate using the actual proposed wholesale receipt, not retail. For example, an assumed $32.50 wholesale receipt on a $65 item, less $18 production, $4 packaging and $3 fulfillment, leaves only $7.50 before transaction fees and other costs. Large orders can reduce some unit costs, but no discount should be presumed. Retail and wholesale require different economics.

Recommended test: Develop one small professionally printed concept and obtain a sample. Ask readers to choose or preorder from a clearly stated design and delivery plan before buying inventory. The strongest first candidates are a weekly reading stand or a short essay edition, depending on the writing available. A limited edition is a production choice, not proof of collector demand.

16 / ADDITIONAL RESEARCH

An app, when it earns its place

Test recurring usefulness before committing to development.



Earlier application studies show possible formats, not final color proofs, finished products or functioning software. Final editions would use the selected saturated aqua and tangerine palette.

Potentially, as a later product with recurring usefulness. An app becomes commercially meaningful when readers return to do something that a book or newsletter does less conveniently. Putting Katie's existing essays behind another icon would not establish a second subscription business.

A first concept could combine a daily reading with saved passages and a simple decision worksheet. A reader could record a choice, identify the information still needed, and return later to examine the outcome. This would let Katie develop a practical method through observed use. It is not a psychological assessment or a clinical service.

Do not build every possible function. Begin with either a useful reading/saving experience or one decision process. Offer a small mobile-friendly web version to a pilot group before commissioning

separate native apps. The goal is to discover repeat use and willingness to pay, not to count downloads. No working app is being delivered in this handoff; the visual is a concept.

A relevant business precedent

Reflection.app says its founders also operate Holstee, connecting an established physical-products and publishing business with a journaling application. It supports a plausible product-development relationship between original content and software. It does not establish Katie's fit, costs, or the desirability of copying Reflection's AI features. https://www.reflection.app/

Reflection also invites creators to submit journaling guides and describes an optional affiliate route. This presents a way to investigate distributing useful writing through an existing app before building software. No fee for guide acceptance or guaranteed content royalty was verified.
https://www.reflection.app/become-a-guide-creator

Its partner page advertises 30% of attributed revenue after fees and refunds, with quarterly payouts and a $50 minimum. Application approval is required. Some guide-link functionality is marked "coming soon" while other sections describe guide attribution; confirm the actual available process with the provider before relying on it. For a purely hypothetical $60 of eligible annual revenue per referred customer, a 30% share is $18; 100 such customers generate $1,800 annually, not monthly, before Katie's own costs.
https://www.reflection.app/affiliate-partner

This affiliate route is a concrete smaller experiment. It does not require buying a development project, and it does not turn Katie into a qualified therapist or guarantee referral conversions.

App income models to investigate

Model	Proposed paid benefit	Main limitation
Standalone recurring access	A continually useful reading library or decision tool	Must justify renewal separately from the newsletter
Included with an existing paid subscription	An interactive way to use the writing	May improve retention, but is not extra subscription revenue from the same reader
One-time paid edition	A defined, finite reading or decision resource	Avoid promising unlimited maintenance for one small payment
Organizational access	A proven tool licensed to a clearly relevant organization	Requires buyer evidence, useful reporting boundaries, and support capacity

Model	Proposed paid benefit	Main limitation
Content supplied to an existing app	Original writing or prompts within someone else's software	Terms may provide exposure rather than direct pay; verify them
Appropriate affiliate partnership	Introductions to a product genuinely useful to Katie's readers	Approval, attribution, and conversion govern income

Illustrative subscription economics

Use $7.99 monthly as a proposed standalone price, not an observed Katie willingness-to-pay figure. Compare a web checkout modeled at 3.5% plus $0.30 with a native subscription modeled at a 15% store commission. Do not subtract both fees from the same native purchase. Other vendor fees, taxes, refunds, and actual store terms may differ.

Apple documents a 15% rate for developers approved for its Small Business Program. Google's current U.S. table lists auto-renewing subscriptions at a 10% service fee plus 5% when using Google Play Billing. Regional and billing choices matter; a 15% scenario is not a universal rule for every app transaction.

https://developer.apple.com/app-store/small-business-program/

https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/112622?hl=en

Hypothetical active monthly app subscribers	Web proceeds after modeled transaction fee	Native proceeds after modeled 15% commission
100	$741.04	$679.15
500	$3,705.18	$3,395.75
1,000	$7,410.35	$6,791.50
2,000	$14,820.70	$13,583.00

The model uses unrounded percentage calculations, so actual transaction-level totals can vary slightly. These are proceeds before development and ongoing operations. A deliberately hypothetical $500 monthly allowance for development amortization and operation, followed by a 25% reserve, requires about 1,507 web-paying subscribers or 1,645 native-paying subscribers to leave $8,000. These are volume requirements, not a customer forecast. The $500 allowance is not a software-development estimate and may be inadequate for the features chosen.

Acquisition can change the conclusion dramatically: if 100 new subscribers cost an assumed $20 each to acquire, that is $2,000 spent before knowing how long they remain. Do not assume paid advertising, app-store listing, or a free trial will provide profitable subscribers.

Minimum evidence before a bigger build

Choose a pilot duration and success criteria in advance. A proposed test would recruit 20-30 genuinely interested readers to use one working feature for four weeks, record whether they return, and invite a real paid continuation. Those sample sizes are operating choices rather than statistically representative evidence. Look for repeated use without constant prompting, a task readers can explain in their own words, and some paid retention.

Before saving personal notes in a cloud service, decide what information is collected and how readers can remove or export it. For an early prototype, avoid collecting sensitive journal histories unnecessarily. The app should support a reader's own reasoning; it does not need an AI chatbot, diagnosis, or an intrusive daily-engagement mechanism.